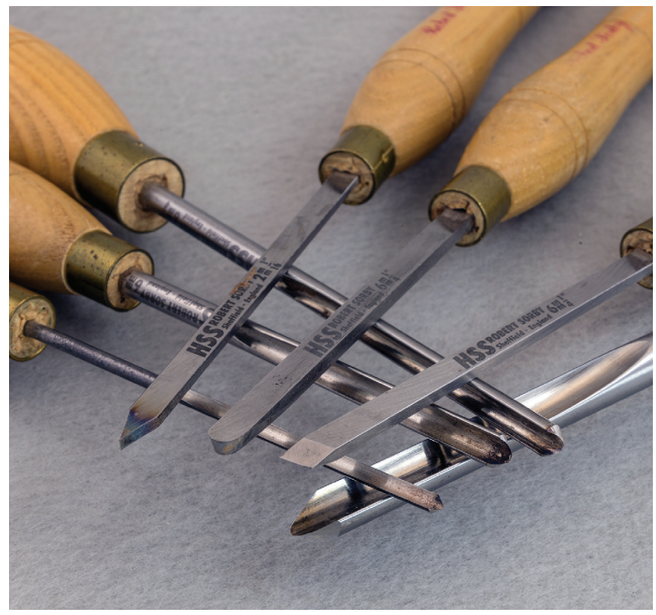
Tools

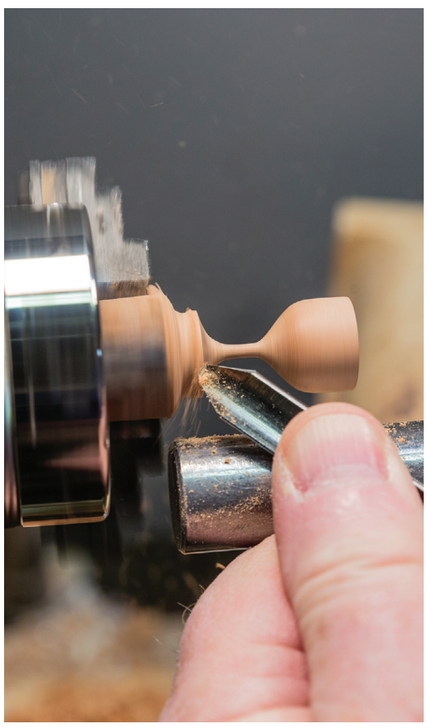
If you usually turn 610mm diameter bowls, changing to turning bracelets may be a dramatic reduction in turning size for you. Your turning tool kit probably contains exactly what you need already. Of course, 45mm roughing gouges aren't going to be useful if you begin doing lace bobbins. There are miniature tool sets available but I caution people to be very selective. Many of these sets aren't in the same league with our standard turning tools and are made by vendors other than the usual makers. Their products are sometimes an idea of what we need rather than designed with experience-based input. Also, many of the sets that I've seen are very inexpensive due to poor material selection and finish. I am not for expense beyond what is appropriate but, for the most part unless you buy foolishly, you get what you pay for. If your regular tool kit has some smaller tools and they'll work as you need them, you are all set.

If you need smaller tools for your planned turning, you may need to adapt your own tools to suit. If you wind up getting into the incredibly small, you can start to adapt dental picks, sewing needles, and other purposed items to do your turning. Please be cautious when you use anything that wasn't expressly designed and built as a woodturning tool. Be certain that you aren't misusing something that can be a hazard to yourself or others.

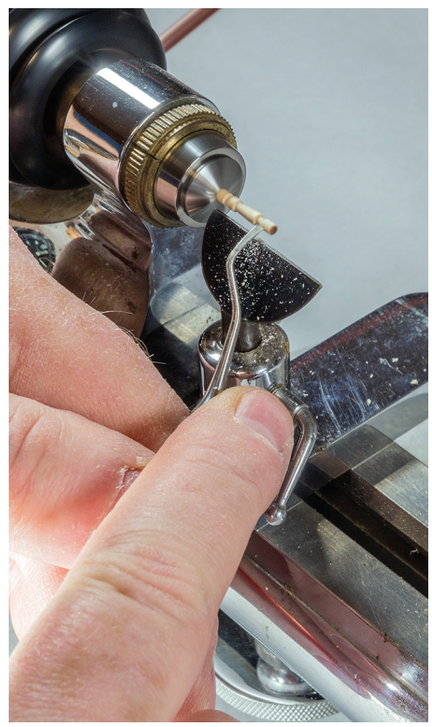
Miniature turning tool sets are available but they require adaptation of most full sized grinding setups



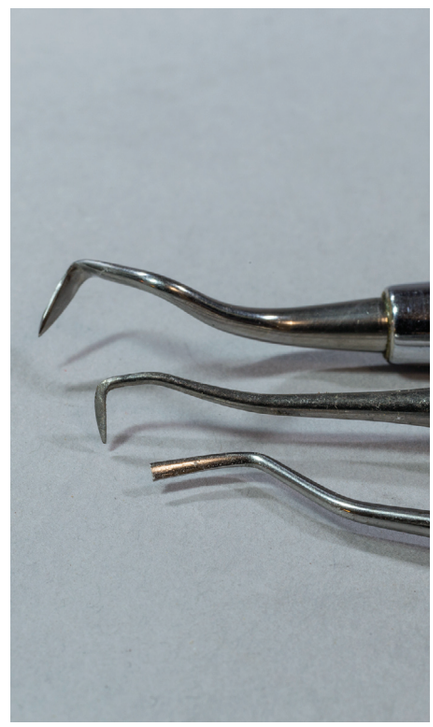
There are smaller tools available from the usual woodturning channels, but often are not standard stock with retailers



When turning small or miniature work, you can often press full sized tools into service with proper grinds



Miniature jewellers gravers or home built mini tools are needed to work on jewellers lathe sized turnings



I find that dental picks can be reshaped and ground to suit. They are available new and unused via eBay

WT_291_75_80_KURT_HERTZOG_vsMBkhbdSD.indd 77 02/03/2016 09:49